

Word family: **jot / jots / jotted / jotting / jottings / jotter**

Base word: jot

Forms: jots, jotted, jotting

Related forms: jotting, jottings, jotter

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Personally, I like finding a corner by the window, reading for an hour or two, and then **jotting down** ideas in a notebook.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **jot down** means **to write something quickly and briefly, usually so that you can remember it later**.

繁體中文：***快速記下；簡單寫下；隨手記錄**

中文翻譯：

> “...then **jotting down** ideas in a notebook.”

「.....然後把一些想法**隨手記在 / 快速記在**筆記本裡。」

Here:

jot down ideas = 把想到的內容快速、簡短地記錄下來，而不是詳細地寫成完整文章

Because **jot down** is the exact construction in the target sentence, it needs explicit treatment even though phrasal verbs are normally excluded unless the passage requires them.

1. **jot = write something quickly and briefly (快速記下) — 匆匆記下；隨手寫下**

This is the main modern verb meaning.

Meaning: To write a short piece of information quickly, usually for later reference or because you do not want to forget it.

Practice 1

> “I **jotted** his phone number on a piece of paper.”

「我把他的電話號碼**隨手記在**一張紙上。」

Practice 2

> “She **jotted** a few ideas in her notebook.”

「她在筆記本裡**快速記下**幾個想法。」

jot = 用很短時間簡單記錄一點資料、想法或提醒

Common objects:

- * jot a note
- * jot an idea
- * jot a number
- * jot a reminder
- * jot a few words

The emphasis is usually:

- * quick
- * brief
- * informal
- * for memory/reference

2. **jot down** = quickly write something for later (片語) — 記下；寫下

This is the exact form used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I like **jotting down** ideas in a notebook.”

「我喜歡把想法**隨手記在**筆記本裡。」

Practice 4

> “Let me **jot down** your address.”

「讓我把你的地址**記下來**。」

Practice 5

> “I **jotted down** a few questions before the meeting.”

「開會前，我**快速記下**了幾個問題。」

jot something down = 為免忘記而快速、簡短地把某事寫下來

The particle **down** reinforces the idea of committing something to writing.

For strict semantic counting, **jot** and **jot down** share the same core meaning.

3. **a jot = a very small amount (名詞) — 一丁點；絲毫**

This is the important second meaning.

As a noun, **jot** means **a tiny amount**, especially in negative or emphatic expressions.

Practice 6

> “I don’t care one **jot** what they think.”

「我**一點也不**在乎他們怎麼想。」

Practice 7

> “His explanation did not help one **jot**.”

「他的解釋**絲毫沒有**幫助。」

Practice 8

> “There wasn’t a **jot** of evidence to support the claim.”

「沒有**一丁點**證據支持這個說法。」

a jot = 非常少的一點；極微小的數量或程度

This use is somewhat more literary/formal than the everyday verb, but it is still established and useful.

Common patterns:

* not a jot

* not one jot

* a jot of something

4. **not a jot = not at all (固定表達) — 一點也不；絲毫不**

This is the most common modern survival of the noun sense.

Practice 9

> “She hasn’t changed a **jot**.”

「她**一點也沒有**改變。」

Practice 10

> “It made not a **jot** of difference.”

「那件事**絲毫沒有**造成差別。」

not a jot = 完全沒有；連極少的一點都沒有

This is a fixed expression rather than a new core meaning.

Related form: **jotting**

A **jotting** is a short, quickly written note.

Practice 11

> “I found an old **jotting** in the back of my notebook.”

「我在筆記本後面找到一則以前隨手寫下的**短記 / 筆記**。」

jotting = 匆匆寫下的簡短筆記

Related form: **jottings**

The plural **jottings** is especially natural for a collection of rough or informal notes.

Practice 12

> “These are just a few **jottings** from the lecture.”

「這些只是我聽講座時隨手寫下的一些**零碎筆記**。」

Practice 13

> “Her notebooks were full of sketches and ****jottings****.”

「她的筆記本裡滿是草圖和****隨手筆記****。」

****jottings** = 零碎、非正式、快速寫下的筆記******

This is useful for the exact semantic field of your sentence.

Related form: ****jotter****

A ****jotter**** can mean a notebook or pad used for making quick notes, particularly in some varieties of British/Irish English.

Practice 14

> “He kept a small ****jotter**** beside the phone.”

「他在電話旁放了一本小****記事簿****。」

****jotter** = 用來隨手記錄的小筆記本 / 記事簿******

This is valid but lower priority than ****jotting****.

Important distinction: ****jot vs write****

****write****

is completely general.

****jot****

specifically suggests writing something:

- * quickly
- * briefly
- * informally

Compare:

> “She wrote a report.”

= 她寫了一份報告。

> “She jotted a reminder.”

= 她隨手記下一個提醒。

You would normally **not** say:

> “She jotted a 5,000-word essay.”

because **jot** implies brevity.

Important distinction: **jot down** vs **note down**

These are very close.

jot down

emphasizes speed and informality.

note down

means record something in writing and is slightly more neutral.

> jot down an idea

> note down the details

Both can mean 「記下來」.

Important distinction: **jot down** vs **take notes**

jot down

usually refers to one or a few short pieces of information.

take notes

usually means systematically record information during:

* a lecture

- * meeting
- * lesson
- * presentation

- > jot down a phone number
- > take notes during a lecture

Important distinction: **jot vs scribble**

jot

focuses on **quick, brief recording**.

scribble

focuses more on **fast or untidy handwriting/drawing**.

- > jot down an idea
- > scribble something on a napkin

A jot can be perfectly neat.

Important distinction: **jot vs jotting**

jot

as a verb:

- > “I jotted the number down.”

jotting

as a noun:

- > “I found a jotting in my notebook.”

So:

jot = 記下

jotting = 隨手寫下的短筆記

Grammar note: **jot** is transitive

Usually:

> **jot + something**

or

> **jot something down**

Examples:

> jot a note

> jot the address down

The spelling doubles the final consonant:

> jot → jotted → jotting

not:

> *joted* ❌

> *joting* ❌

Countability note

The noun senses are countable.

Tiny amount

> a jot

> not one jot

Short note

Usually the derived noun:

> a jotting

> several jottings

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is compact:

* **jot**
* **jots**
* **jotted**
* **jotting**
* **jottings**
* **jotter**

The word has two genuinely different semantic branches:

1. **quickly write something**
2. **a very small amount**

The second survives especially strongly in:

> **not a jot / not one jot**

The family is therefore small, but it is genuine polysemy rather than merely different writing contexts.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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jot — verb	快速而簡短地把資料、想法或提醒寫下來
jot down	為免忘記而隨手、快速記下某事
a jot — noun	極少的一點；一丁點；絲毫
not a jot	一點也不；絲毫沒有
jotting	一則匆匆寫下的簡短筆記
jottings	一些零碎、隨手寫下的筆記
jotter	用來隨手記錄的小記事簿；較低頻

For your original sentence

> “...and then **jotting down** ideas in a notebook.”

The exact meaning is:

****jotting down = 把剛想到的想法快速、簡短地寫進筆記本，以免忘記****

So:

> ****jot down ideas****

= **隨手記下想法 / 快速把想法寫下來**

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **jot**:

1. **verb — quickly and briefly write something**
2. **noun — a very small amount**

I would keep **jot down** as the essential target construction, and keep **jotting / jottings / jotter** as family extensions rather than inflate the core count.